

SPX Options Flow — Weekly Macro Briefing

Weekly Options Flow & Dealer Positioning Analysis

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▼ SHORT GAMMA

RISK: EXTREME

Composite Score: -0.06

SPX SPOT 6,575	NET GEX -4728.29B	GAMMA FLIP 5,992	DIST. TO FLIP +8.9%	CALL WALL #1 6,650	PUT WALL #1 6,600
MAX PAIN 6,690			VIX 25.37		

Dealers are in SHORT GAMMA with net GEX of \$-4728.29B. Spot (6,575) sits 8.9% above the gamma flip level (5,992). Composite macro score: -0.06 → Risk Level: EXTREME. Key risks: BEARISH_VOL_BUY, OPEX 1DTE, BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY.

REGIME PLAYBOOK

▲ EQUITIES

Reduce net delta, buy downside puts for protection

◆ VOLATILITY

Long VIX, buy volatility — trend moves may persist

◆ OPTIONS STRATEGY

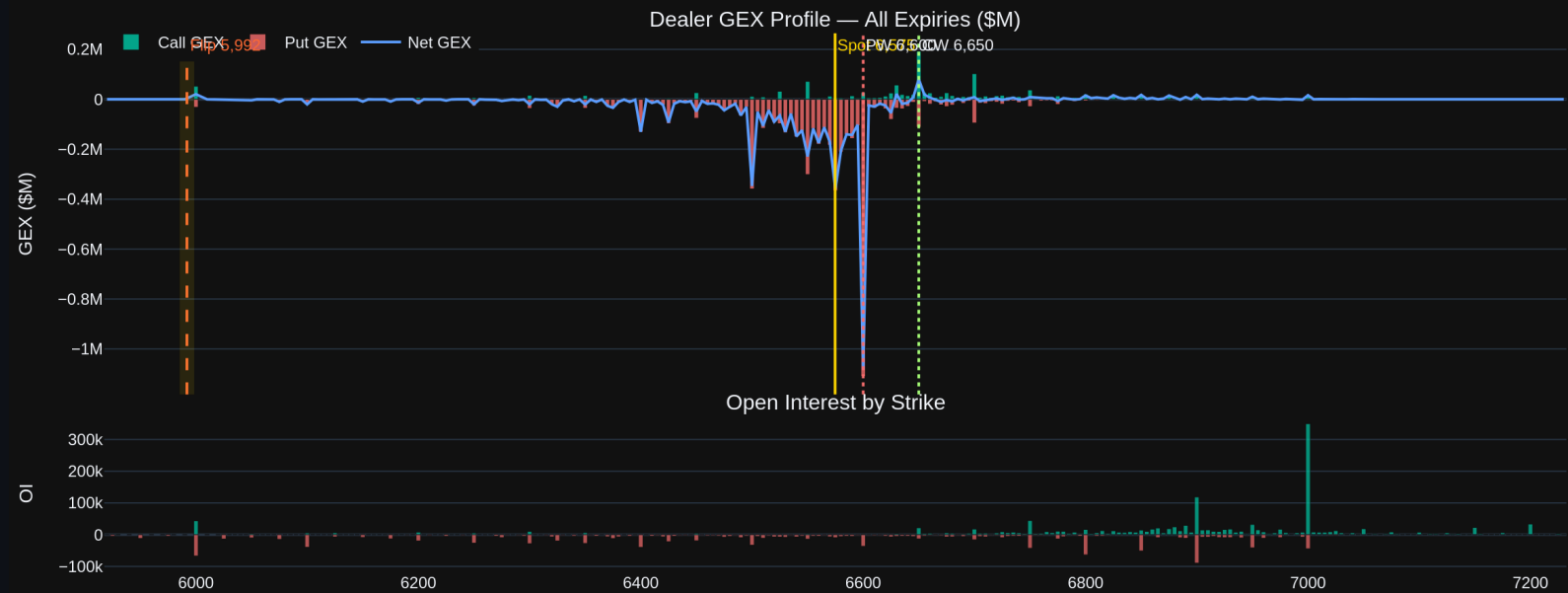
Long straddles, buy gamma for directional exposure

◆ POSITION SIZING

Reduce 30–50% — elevated tail risk in short-gamma regime

GEX Profile — Dealer Gamma Exposure

March 19, 2026



KEY LEVELS

STRIKE	TYPE	GEX	DIST. FROM SPOT	INTERPRETATION
6,650	Call Wall	+192.4B	+1.1%	Strong resistance / dealer selling above spot
6,700	Call Wall	+102.9B	+1.9%	Strong resistance / dealer selling above spot
6,550	Call Wall	+71.9B	-0.4%	Below-spot call concentration / dealer buyback support
6,600	Put Wall	-1110.5B	+0.4%	Near-ATM pin/magnet (+0.4%) — ITM put concentration; dealers long delta that unwinds if spot closes above this strike
6,575	Put Wall	-365.9B	+0.0%	Near-ATM pin/magnet (+0.0%) — ITM put concentration; dealers long delta that unwinds if spot closes above this strike
6,500	Put Wall	-359.2B	-1.1%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure below spot

OPEX: 2026-03-20 (1 DTE)

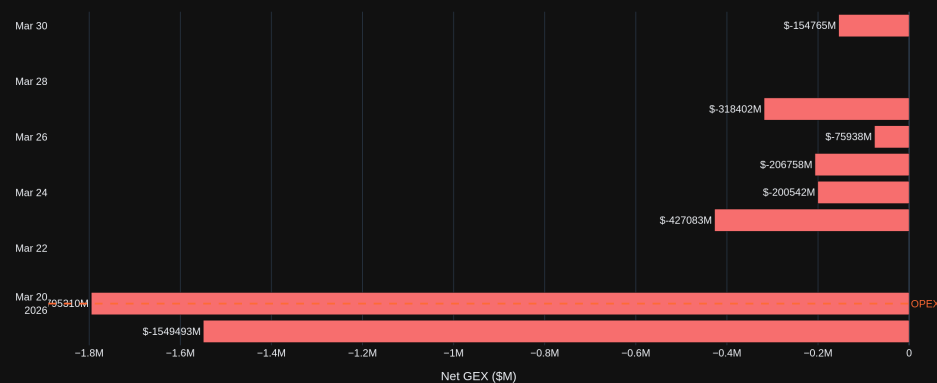
Net GEX Expiring	% of Total Book
\$-1795310M	38.0%

Expiry Roll-Off & Delta Exposure

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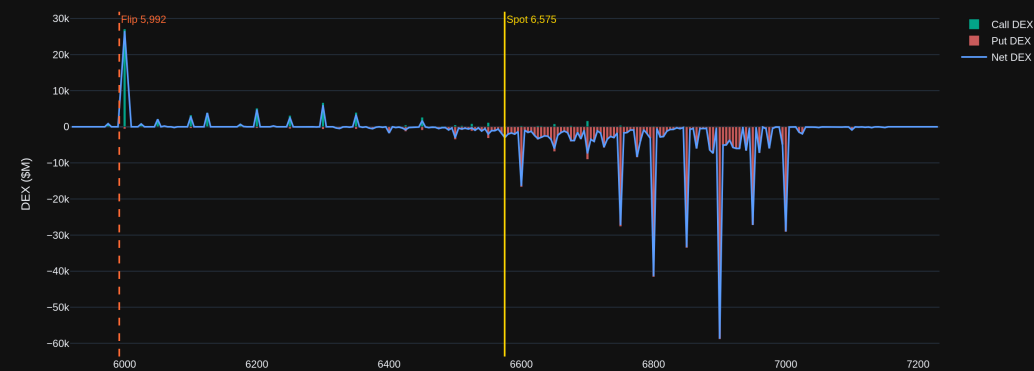
GEX BY EXPIRY

Net GEX by Expiry — Roll-Off Profile (\$M)



DEX PROFILE

Dealer Delta Exposure (DEX) by Strike (\$M)



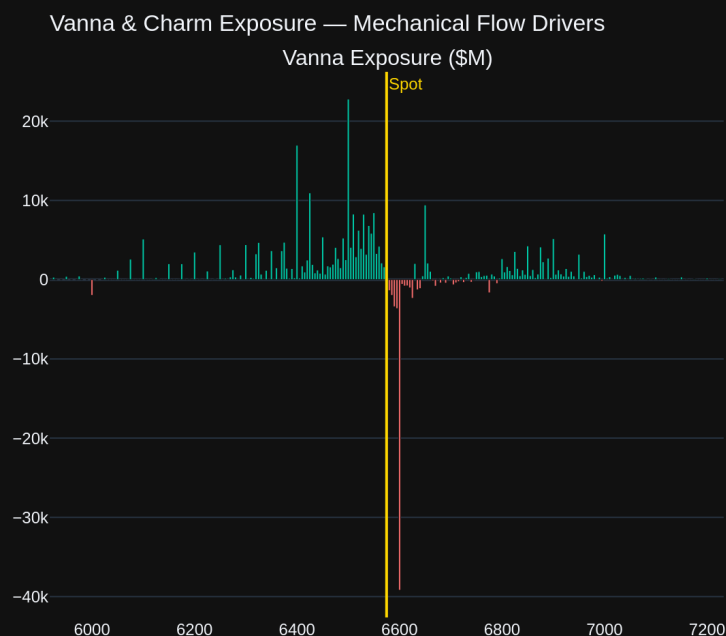
OPEX-SPECIFIC GEX (2026-03-20)

GEX Profile — 2026-03-20 (OPEX Only)



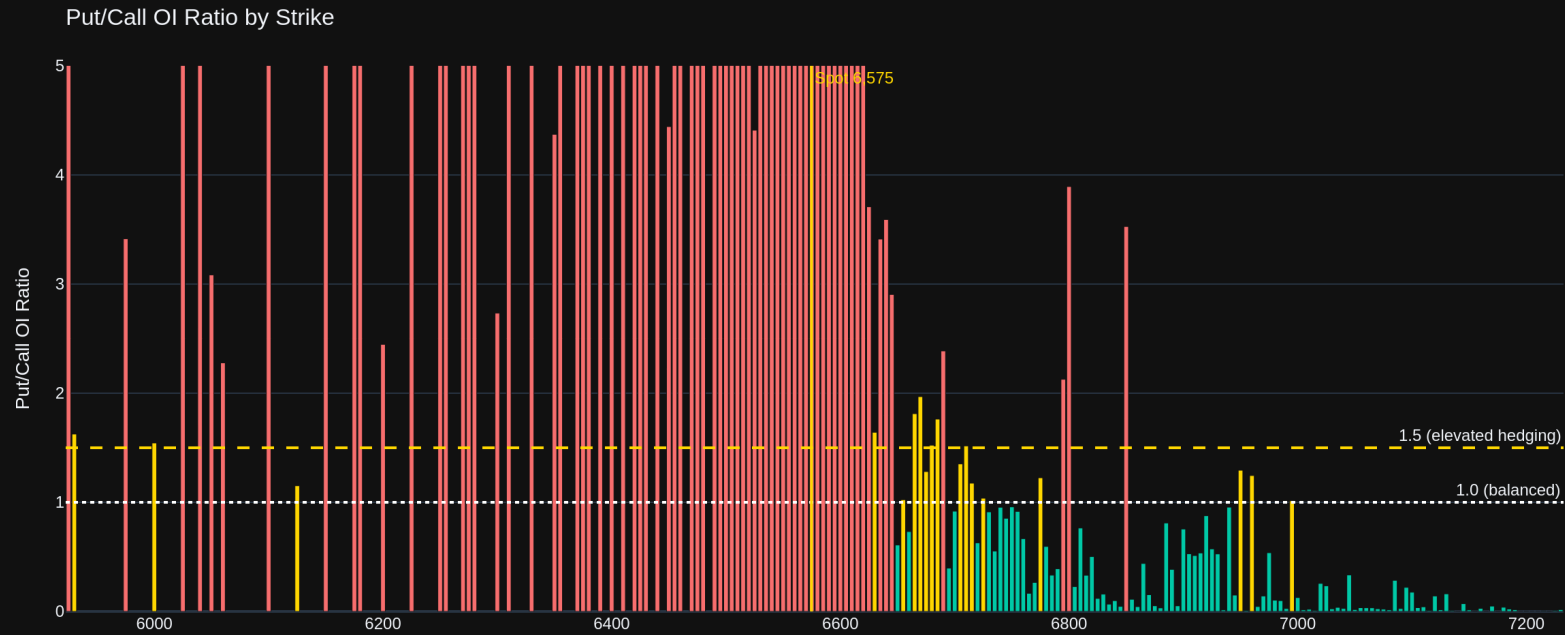
Max Pain: 6,690 — Market tends to gravitate toward max-pain strike in the final trading sessions before OPEX as dealers neutralise hedges.

VANNA & CHARM EXPOSURE



Vanna ($d\Delta/d\sigma$): when implied vol changes, dealers mechanically re-hedge their delta. Positive net vanna exposure = vol compression creates systematic equity buying pressure. Negative net vanna = vol expansion creates systematic equity selling pressure. **Charm ($d\Delta/dT$ per day):** delta decays daily with time even if price does not move. Near OPEX this effect accelerates sharply and can distort intraday price action.

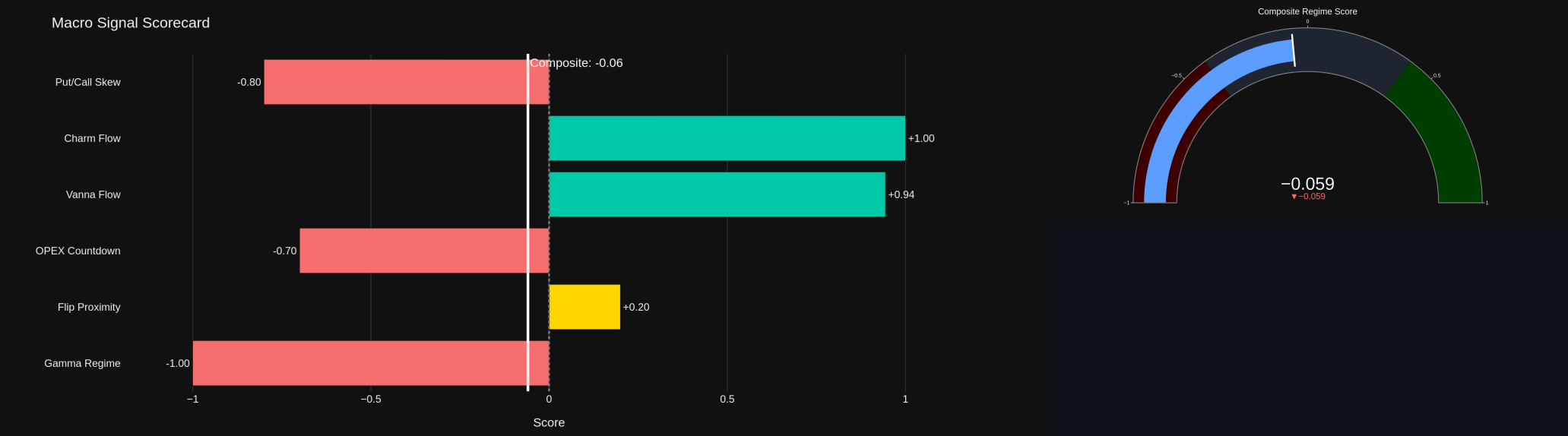
PUT/CALL OI RATIO BY STRIKE



Put/Call OI Ratio (this chart): open-interest-based ratio per strike. Strikes with OI ratio > 1.5 have heavy put accumulation relative to calls — typically defensive institutional hedging. Strikes near zero or NaN had insufficient call OI (< 10 contracts) and are suppressed. **Note:** the Put/Call Skew signal on the Signal Dashboard uses a separate *GEX-weighted* ratio (total put GEX / total call GEX), not this OI chart. The two metrics are related but not identical — OI ratio reflects positioning volume, GEX ratio reflects gamma exposure and dealer hedging pressure.

Macro Signal Dashboard

March 19, 2026



SIGNAL DETAIL

Gamma Regime

BEARISH_VOL_BUY

-1.00

STRONG

Net GEX = \$-4728.29B → dealers are SHORT GAMMA. Spot is 8.9% above gamma flip at 5,992.

- Equities: trending moves more likely, reduce net delta exposure
- Vol: VIX spikes may persist — avoid short vol
- Options: long gamma / straddles for directional flexibility

Flip Proximity

ABOVE FLIP: STABLE

+0.20

WEAK

Spot (6,575) is 8.9% above gamma flip (5,992). Dealer support likely on dips toward flip.

- Watch 5,992 as key inflection — sustained close above = regime shift
- Volatility clustering risk increases near flip

OPEX Countdown

OPEX 1DTE

-0.70

STRONG

OPEX in 1 DTE (CRITICAL urgency). \$-1795310M net GEX expiring = 38.0% of total book. Pin behaviour likely near OPEX strikes.

- Pin risk: market may gravitate to max-pain strike $\pm 0.5\%$ as OPEX approaches
- Post-OPEX: expect vol reset once large GEX concentration expires
- Book impact: 38.0% of dealer delta hedging unwind at OPEX

Vanna Flow

VOL_FALL_BID_DAMPENED

+0.94

STRONG

Vanna exposure = \$+232094M. Vol compression → mechanical equity bid via delta re-hedging. VIX 1d change: +0.28 (rising) — diverging with vanna signal.

- Vol decline → dealer delta re-hedging creates systematic equity buying
- Watch VIX 1d direction as leading indicator of vanna flow direction
- Strong positive vanna + falling VIX = powerful mechanical tailwind

Charm Flow

DAILY_DELTA_INFLOW

+1.00

STRONG

Charm exposure = \$+8071M/day. DTE=0: charm acceleration is sharp near expiry. Positive charm = net delta accrual as time passes.

- Charm creates mechanical daily delta flows even with no price movement
- Near OPEX, charm accelerates and can distort intraday price action

Put/Call Skew

BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY

-0.80

STRONG

Put/Call GEX ratio = 4.28. Heavy put protection in dealer books — bearish defensive positioning. Put wall at 6,600 (+0.4% from spot).

- High put skew: dealers short puts → forced to sell into weakness, amplifying downside moves
- Hedging demand exceeds upside speculation — institutional risk-off signal

CROSS-ASSET GEX SUMMARY

INSTRUMENT	SPOT	NET GEX (\$B)	REGIME	FLIP LEVEL	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL	PUT WALL
SPX — S&P 500 Index	6,574.76	-4728.29B	SHORT GAMMA	5,991.90	+8.9%	6,650	6,600
SPY — SPDR S&P 500 ETF	nan	+0.00B	LONG GAMMA	245.00	+0.0%	245	245
QQQ — Invesco QQQ ETF	nan	+0.00B	LONG GAMMA	205.00	+0.0%	205	205
IWM — iShares Russell 2000 ETF	244.58	-325.77B	SHORT GAMMA	267.50	-9.4%	245	245

⚠ REGIME DIVERGENCE DETECTED — Long-gamma: SPY, QQQ; Short-gamma: SPX, IWM. Mixed positioning: dealers absorbing moves in long-gamma names while amplifying them in short-gamma names.

Divergence between SPY, QQQ (long-gamma, stable) and SPX, IWM (short-gamma, trending) signals potential sector rotation or flow concentration risk. Monitor cross-asset vol and relative GEX size to assess which regime is dominant.